Marketing Tools Benchmark

Odoo 19 Marketing Suite vs. Specialist Software — Honest Assessment

Prepared for Kebony CMO — March 2026 | Confidential

Executive Summary

Odoo 19 includes five marketing modules (Email, Automation, SMS, Social, Events) bundled at no extra cost with the ERP. For a **B2B manufacturer/distributor** like Kebony, they cover 70–80% of typical marketing needs. The remaining 20–30% — advanced automation workflows, email deliverability, social listening, and multi-touch attribution — require specialist tools if the marketing team's ambitions go beyond newsletters and event management.

Bottom line: Start with Odoo. Add specialists only where you hit a concrete wall — not on speculation.

📧 Email Marketing

What Odoo 19 Can Do

- Drag-and-drop email builder with mobile-responsive templates
- AI-powered subject line and content suggestions (new in v19)
- A/B testing on subject lines and content
- Advanced segmentation based on behaviour, demographics, purchase history
- Real-time stats: open rate, bounce rate, CTR, revenue tracking
- Link Tracker with UTM parameters
- GDPR-compliant unsubscribe and opt-in management

- **Native CRM/Sales integration** — leads, orders, revenue per campaign tracked automatically

Where Specialists Are Better

Capability	Odoo	Mailchimp	ActiveCampaign	HubSpot
Template library	Basic (~20)	300+ templates	250+ templates	200+ templates
Deliverability infrastructure	Shared, reports of spam issues	Dedicated, best-in-class	Dedicated IP option	Dedicated IP option
Send-time optimisation	None	AI-based per recipient	ML-based	ML-based
Multi-touch attribution	None	Basic	Basic	Full revenue attribution
Third-party integrations	Odoo ecosystem only	300+ native	900+ native	500+ native
CRM/ERP integration	Native (same database)	API sync needed	Native CRM, no ERP	Native CRM, no ERP

Verdict: Good Enough for Kebony — Adequate for distributor newsletters, product announcements, and event invitations. The native CRM/ERP integration is a genuine advantage. Consider Mailchimp or ActiveCampaign only if deliverability becomes a measurable problem (emails consistently landing in spam).

⚙️ Marketing Automation

What Odoo 19 Can Do

- Visual workflow builder with drag-and-drop
- Activities: Email, SMS, Server Action (update records, assign leads)

- Conditional branching: Opened / Not Opened / Replied / Clicked / Bounced
- Timing delays: hours, days, weeks, months
- CRM integration: auto-assign leads, move pipeline stages, update records
- Lead scoring based on demographic and behavioural criteria
- Test mode before activation

Where Specialists Are Better

Capability	Odoo	HubSpot	ActiveCampaign
Activity types	3 (Email, SMS, Server Action)	20+ (incl. tasks, Slack, webhooks)	15+ (incl. webhooks, site events)
Workflow templates	6 starter templates	200+ pre-built	900+ recipes
Website behaviour triggers	None	Page views, form fills, scroll depth	Site tracking, event tracking
Goal-based campaigns	None	Auto-remove on conversion	Goal tracking per workflow
A/B testing in workflows	Not available	Native	Split actions
Predictive lead scoring	Manual rules only	ML-based	ML-based
Multi-channel orchestration	Email + SMS only	Email + SMS + push + in-app + ads	Email + SMS + site messages

Verdict: Basic — Sufficient for Simple Nurture — Works for straightforward sequences (welcome series, event follow-up, distributor onboarding). Not suitable for complex B2B buyer journeys with multiple touchpoints, conditional paths, and behavioural triggers. If the marketing team wants sophisticated automation, HubSpot or ActiveCampaign is significantly more capable.

💬 SMS Marketing

What Odoo 19 Can Do

- Campaign creation with dynamic placeholders
- A/B testing for SMS campaigns
- Scheduling, opt-out compliance, blacklist management
- Link tracking with revenue attribution
- Credit-based pricing (~$0.033/SMS to US)
- Integrated with email and social campaigns

What Odoo Lacks

- No two-way SMS conversations (reply handling)
- No keyword-based auto-responses
- No MMS support (images/media)
- No BYO-carrier option (locked to Odoo gateway)
- Per-credit pricing can be expensive at scale vs. volume contracts

> **Verdict: Adequate for B2B** — SMS is rarely a primary channel for B2B timber distribution. Odoo's SMS module covers what Kebony would need (delivery notifications, event reminders, urgent customer alerts). Two-way SMS and MMS are nice-to-haves, not must-haves in this context.

📱 Social Media Marketing

What Odoo 19 Can Do

- Centralised dashboard: Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter/X, YouTube
- Multi-platform post scheduling and publishing
- Reply to comments/messages from within Odoo
- Lead generation from social comments (Create Lead button)

- Link tracking with revenue attribution
- Push Notifications as a channel
- Kanban, calendar, list, and pivot views

Where Specialists Are Better

Capability	Odoo	Hootsuite	Buffer	Sprout Social
Social listening	None	Brand monitoring, trends	None	Sentiment analysis
Competitive benchmarking	None	Yes	None	Detailed reports
Optimal posting time	None	AI-recommended	AI-recommended	Data-driven
Ad management	None	Boost posts	None	Paid campaign mgmt
Approval workflows	None	Team review	Approval flow	Full workflow
Content calendar (drag & drop)	Basic calendar only	Full drag-and-drop	Visual calendar	Full calendar
Pricing (per year)	Included in Odoo	$3K–15K+	~$1,200	$18K+ (5 users)

Verdict: Basic Scheduler — Fine for Kebony's Needs — Adequate for scheduling LinkedIn posts, project updates, and product content. If the CMO wants social listening or competitive monitoring, add **Buffer ($100/mo)** as a lightweight supplement — it's cheap and simple. Avoid Hootsuite/Sprout Social pricing unless there's a dedicated social team.

🎪 Events

What Odoo 19 Can Do

- Full event lifecycle: creation, ticketing, registration, promotion, follow-up
- Multi-slot scheduling (attendees pick specific sessions)
- Schedule & Tracks management (talks, demos, workshops)
- Live broadcast via YouTube integration
- Online exhibitors and sponsor showcase
- Virtual conferencing via Jitsi integration
- Booth management with tiered pricing
- Barcode/QR code attendance scanning
- Event gamification with quizzes
- Native CRM integration (leads from events)
- Automated triggers: before/after event start (new in v19)

What Specialists Offer Extra

- **Cvent** ($15–50K/yr): RFID/NFC badge tracking, venue sourcing, lead retrieval for exhibitors, branded mobile app
- **Eventbrite** (pay-per-ticket): Massive public discovery marketplace (millions of visitors)
- **Bizzabo**: AI-powered attendee networking/matching, hybrid event platform

> **Verdict: Genuinely Strong** — Odoo Events is the best module in the marketing suite. For Kebony's needs (distributor days, trade shows, training events, product launches), it's fully capable. The native CRM integration means event leads flow directly into the sales pipeline. No specialist needed unless running 1000+ person conferences.

💰 Cost Comparison

Based on Kebony's profile: ~50 ERP users, 5–10 active marketing users, B2B context.

Odoo 19 (All-in-One)

€0 extra

Marketing modules included in existing Odoo subscription

- Email Marketing ✓
- Marketing Automation ✓
- SMS Marketing ✓ (credits extra)
- Social Media ✓
- Events ✓
- Already integrated with CRM, Sales, Inventory

HubSpot Marketing Hub Professional

~€35K/yr

$890/mo base + seat fees + onboarding $3K

- Advanced automation ✓
- Predictive lead scoring ✓
- Revenue attribution ✓
- A/B testing everywhere ✓
- ⚠️ Separate CRM (data sync with Odoo needed)
- ⚠️ Contact-based pricing adds up

ActiveCampaign Pro

~€5–8K/yr

Contact-based pricing, ~$149/mo for 10K contacts

- 900+ automation templates ✓
- Best-in-class deliverability ✓
- Site tracking ✓
- Built-in CRM (basic) ✓
- ⚠️ No ERP integration (API sync needed)

- ⚠️ No events module

Lightweight Stack

~€3–5K/yr

Mailchimp Standard + Buffer + Eventbrite

- Good email deliverability ✓
- Simple social scheduling ✓
- Pay-per-ticket events ✓
- ⚠️ Three separate tools to manage
- ⚠️ No CRM/ERP integration
- ⚠️ No unified campaign view

🎯 Recommendation for Kebony

Phase 1 — Start with Odoo (Now)

- **Email Marketing** — distributor newsletters, product launches, customer communications
- **Events** — distributor days, trade shows, training sessions
- **Social Media** — LinkedIn scheduling, project showcases, product content
- **Marketing Automation** — welcome sequences, event follow-ups, simple lead nurture
- **Benefit**: zero additional cost, single source of truth with CRM/Sales/Inventory

Phase 2 — Add Supplements If Needed (3–6 months)

- **If email deliverability is a problem** → evaluate ActiveCampaign (~€5K/yr) or Mailchimp (~€2K/yr) for critical campaigns only
- **If social needs grow** → add Buffer (~€1.2K/yr) for optimal posting times and content calendar

- **If marketing team demands complex automation** → evaluate HubSpot Marketing Hub, but only with a clear ROI case (it's €35K+/yr)

What NOT to Do

- Don't buy HubSpot "just in case" — it's expensive and creates a data silo
- Don't maintain two CRMs (Odoo + HubSpot) — that's a recipe for data chaos
- Don't underestimate Odoo's native integration advantage — leads, orders, inventory, and marketing in one system is genuinely powerful for a manufacturer

🎬 Recommended Videos

For the CMO to evaluate Odoo marketing capabilities hands-on:

📧 **Email Marketing Essentials**

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

Official tutorial — setup, templates, campaigns

📧 **Email Campaigns & A/B Testing**

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

A/B testing, segmentation, analytics

⚙️ **Marketing Automation Essentials**

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

Workflows, triggers, lead scoring

📱 **Social Marketing Basics**

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

Multi-platform scheduling, engagement

📱 **Social Marketing Campaigns**

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

Unified campaigns across channels

🎪 Events — Full Course (14 lessons)

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

~1h50m — complete event management walkthrough

🎪 Business Flow: Events & Marketing

Watch on Odoo eLearning →

End-to-end event + marketing workflow

📚 Full Marketing Course Hub

Browse all marketing tutorials →

All Odoo marketing modules in one place

📊 At-a-Glance Summary

Module	Odoo Rating	Verdict	Specialist Needed?
Email Marketing	★★★☆☆	Good for B2B newsletters. Deliverability is the risk.	Only if spam issues measured
Marketing Automation	★★☆☆☆	Basic nurture sequences OK. Complex journeys: no.	If CMO wants advanced workflows
SMS Marketing	★★★☆☆	Adequate. SMS is secondary for B2B timber.	No
Social Media	★★☆☆☆	Basic scheduler. No listening or analytics.	Buffer ($100/mo) if team wants more
Events	★★★★☆	Genuinely strong. Best module in the suite.	No (unless 1000+ person conferences)

CRM/ERP Integration	★★★★★	Unbeatable. Single source of truth.	This is Odoo's killer advantage

Prepared by VVF Consulting — March 2026 | For internal Kebony decision-making only
Sources: Odoo 19 documentation, G2 reviews, vendor websites, independent benchmarks